

START HERE

How to play

- 1 Find your child's color.
- 2 Pick a card, or let your child pick.
- 3 Play for five minutes or more.
- 4 Try the talk tip. Then wait.

 **0–1** year

 **1–2** years

 **2–3** years

 **3–5** years



-  Every card: a grown-up plays along and stays within reach.

▲ 0–1 yr

01



Peekaboo Cloth

YOU NEED A dish towel

Hide your face behind the towel, then pop out: “Peekaboo!” Later, let baby pull it off your head.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Pause before “boo.” A kick, a grin or a squeal is baby’s turn.



Put the towel away after play; never leave it in the crib.

▲ 0–1 yr

02



Copy Cat Faces

YOU NEED Just you

Hold baby face to face, close enough to see you well. Open wide, smile big, stick out your tongue. Watch baby try it too.



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

Copy baby's sounds back: "ba" becomes "ba-ba!" Then wait for another.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

03



Kitchen Drum

YOU NEED A pot and a wooden spoon

Turn the pot upside down on the floor. Tap it, then hand baby the spoon. Take turns: soft, then loud.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

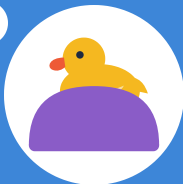
Name the sounds as they happen:
“Bang! Bang! Soft... LOUD!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

04



Where's Duck?

YOU NEED A big toy and a towel

Hide the toy under the towel with a little bit showing. Ask “Where’s duck?” and let baby find it. Cheer!



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Ask, then count to five in your head before you help.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

05



Bubble Watch

YOU NEED Bubbles

Blow a few bubbles slowly above baby. Let baby watch, reach and pop. Blow again when baby looks at you.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Use the same short words each time:
“Up, up... pop!”



A grown-up holds the bottle. Wipe bubble mix off little hands.

▲ 0–1 yr

06



Rock and Stop

YOU NEED A song you know

Hold baby and sway while you sing.
Stop in the middle and wait. Start again
when baby wiggles or looks at you.



TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE

The pause is the game. Baby's wiggle means "more!"



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

07



Roll It Back

YOU NEED A big soft ball

For babies who can sit: sit facing each other, legs apart. Roll the ball to baby, then help roll it back.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Say “Ready... roll!” and wait for baby to look at you first.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

08



First Book Chat

YOU NEED A board book

Sit baby on your lap. Point to one picture and name it. Let baby pat the pictures and help turn the pages.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Talk about whatever baby looks at, even the same page again.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

09



In and Out

YOU NEED A basket and 4–5 big toys

Drop toys into the basket one by one:
“In!” Tip them out: “Out!” Let baby dump
and fill.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

One word for each move: “in,” “out,”
“all gone!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

10



Leaf Hello

YOU NEED A tree or a big plant

Carry baby close to a tree or a window plant. Touch a leaf together, look up at the sky, feel the breeze.



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

Name it, then add one word: “Leaf.
Green leaf. Soft leaf.”



Stay within reach. Leaves and petals stay out of mouths.

▲ 0–1 yr

11



Tickle Countdown

YOU NEED Just you

Wiggle your fingers in the air: “One... two... three...” then a gentle tickle. Do it again, a little slower.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Stop at “two...” A squeal or a kick asks for “three!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

12



Stack and Crash

YOU NEED Plastic cups or big blocks

Stack three cups into a tower. Let baby knock it over. Cheer, and build it again together.



TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE

Say “up, up, up... crash!” and throw your arms wide on “crash.”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

13



Sock Off!

YOU NEED A clean sock

Slip a loose sock halfway onto baby's foot. Let baby pull it off: "Sock off!" Try the other foot.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say it as it happens: "Foot! Sock on... sock off!"



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

14



Box Car

YOU NEED A big cardboard box

Your toddler sits in the box. Push it slowly around the room. Stop at “stations” to wave hello.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Say “Ready, set...” and wait for “go!”
Any sound counts.



Push slowly on the floor. Pull out staples and tape first.

1–2 yrs

15



Stir the Soup

YOU NEED A pot, a big spoon, big blocks

Drop blocks into the pot and stir. Blow on the “hot” soup. Serve a spoonful to a teddy.



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

Ask “Hot soup or cold soup?” Hold up two hands and wait.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

16



Animal Voices

YOU NEED Toy animals or a picture book

Hold up an animal and make its sound.
Pass it to your child. Swap animals and
go again.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Say “The cow says...” and leave a gap
for “moo.”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

17



Pour and Splash

YOU NEED A tub of water, 2 plastic cups

Set the tub on a towel. Pour water from cup to cup. Let your child pour, splash and fill.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Talk as it happens: “Full... empty! Pour, pour.”



Water play: a grown-up within arm’s reach the whole time. Tip the water out after.

1–2 yrs

18



Block Tower

YOU NEED Big blocks

Build a tower together, one block each.
Count as you go. Let them knock it
down and start again.



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

They say “block,” you say “big block!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

19



Hat Parade

YOU NEED 3–4 hats from around the house

Try on hats in front of a mirror. Make a silly face in each one. March around the room.



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

Ask “Sun hat or winter hat?” Let them choose yours too.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

20



Pillow Mountain

YOU NEED Couch cushions

Pile the cushions on the floor to make a mountain. Help your child climb up, then slide down.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say it as they move: “Up, up, up!
Down!”



On the floor, away from furniture corners.
Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

21



Sock Toss

YOU NEED A basket of clean socks

Toss socks into the basket. Find a big one and a tiny one. Hide one on your head!



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE
“Sock” becomes “big sock!” or “red sock!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

22



Teddy's Bedtime

YOU NEED A stuffed toy, a small towel

Tuck teddy in with the towel. Read teddy a book, sing teddy a song, whisper “night-night.”



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

If they feed teddy instead, talk about the snack.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

23



Chair Tunnel

YOU NEED Two chairs and a blanket

Drape the blanket over two chairs to make a tunnel. Crawl through together, then take turns.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say the word as they move: “In... through... out!”



Use sturdy chairs that won't tip. Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

24



Clap and Stomp

YOU NEED Just you

Clap twice, stomp twice, pat your knees.
Let your child copy you, then you copy
their moves.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Copy whatever they do. They're the
leader now.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

25



Pull-Out Box

YOU NEED An empty tissue box, 6 washcloths

Stuff the washcloths into the box. Your child pulls them out one by one. Stuff them back in and go again.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Hold one up: “More?” Wait for a look, a point or a sound.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

26



Kick and Chase

YOU NEED A big soft ball

Roll or kick the ball across the room.
Race to it together. Catch it and sit on it!



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

Ask “Kick it or roll it?” Show both,
then wait.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

27



Blanket Fort

YOU NEED A blanket, chairs, pillows

Build a fort together. Bring in a book and a teddy. Read inside, then peek out the door.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Use place words: “in,” “under,” “on top,” “behind.”



Sturdy chairs only; nothing heavy on top. Stay within reach.

★ 2–3 yrs

28



Tea Party

YOU NEED Cups, plates, stuffed toys

Set a pretend table for the toys. Pour pretend tea, pass pretend cake, and clink cups: “Cheers!”



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

Ask as Bear: “More tea? Milk or honey?” Wait for the answer.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

29



Color Sort

YOU NEED Big blocks in 3 colors, 3 bowls

Put one of each color in a bowl. Your child sorts the rest. Mix them all up and sort again.



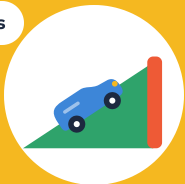
TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE
“Red” becomes “red block goes here!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

30



Car Ramp

YOU NEED A board or big book, toy cars

Prop the board on the sofa to make a ramp. Race the cars down. Which one goes the farthest?



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say what happens: “Fast! Slow! Crash!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

31



Big Paper Art

YOU NEED Big paper, chunky crayons, tape

Tape the paper to the floor. Draw lines, dots and circles side by side. Swap crayons now and then.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Describe, don't quiz: "Round and round. A big circle!"



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

32



Freeze Dance

YOU NEED A song to sing or play

Dance to a song. When the music stops, freeze! Take turns being the one who stops the music.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

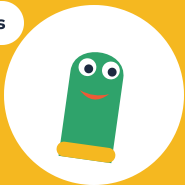
Let your child shout “stop!” and “go!” for you.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

33



Sock Puppet Chat

YOU NEED A clean sock, a marker

Draw eyes on a sock and slip it on your hand. The puppet says hello, asks a question, then waits.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Puppets are patient. Give extra time to answer.



Draw the face on. No buttons or stick-on eyes.

★ 2–3 yrs

34



Nature Basket

YOU NEED A basket, a walk outside

Collect big leaves, sticks and pinecones.
At home, sort them: bumpy, smooth,
big, small.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Name how they feel: “Bumpy
pinecone. Smooth stick.”



Only things bigger than a toilet-paper tube.
Skip berries and mushrooms.

★ 2–3 yrs

35



Pretend Shop

YOU NEED Empty food boxes, a bag

Set up a shop on the sofa. Your child fills the bag and pays you with a leaf. Then swap jobs.



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

Ask “Cereal or crackers today?” and wait.



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

36



Toy Bath

YOU NEED A tub of water, a washable toy, a cloth

Give the toy a bath: wash its hands, feet and tummy. Dry it with a towel and tuck it in.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

**Name body parts: “Wash the toes.
Now the knees!”**



Water play: a grown-up within arm’s reach the whole time. Tip the water out after.

★ 2–3 yrs

37



Animal Moves

YOU NEED Space to move

Hop like a frog, stomp like an elephant, tiptoe like a cat. Take turns picking the animal.



TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE

Add the sound and the move: “Hop, hop, ribbit!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

38



Shape Hunt

YOU NEED Just you

Walk around the house looking for circles: a plate, a clock, a wheel. Then hunt for squares.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Point and name: “Round, like the clock!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

39



Little Helper

YOU NEED A damp cloth

Wipe the table together after a meal.
Then let your child wipe a chair, then a
toy.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

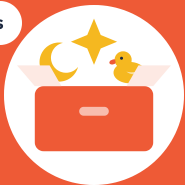
Talk as you work: “Wipe, wipe. All
clean!”



Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a
toilet-paper tube.

● 3–5 yrs

40



Story Box

YOU NEED A box, 3 toys from around the house

Pull out 3 toys. Make up a story that uses all three. Take turns adding one sentence each.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Let the story go anywhere. Ask, “And then what?”



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

41



Obstacle Course

YOU NEED Pillows, a chair, a blanket

Build a course: crawl under the chair, hop over the pillows, roll across the blanket.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

Give two-step directions: “Crawl under, then jump!” Then swap.



Clear the space of sharp corners. A grown-up stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

42



I Spy Colors

YOU NEED Just you

“I spy something green.” Your child guesses. Then they pick something and give you the clue.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

If they get stuck, add a hint: “It’s round...”



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

43



Restaurant

YOU NEED Paper, crayons, plates

Draw a menu together. Your child takes your order, “cooks” it and brings it to the table. Swap roles.



TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE

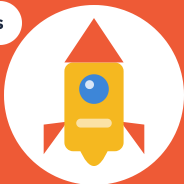
Ask “Soup or pizza? Anything else?”



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

44



Box Rocket

YOU NEED A big box, crayons

Draw buttons and windows on the box.
Climb in, count down from ten, and
blast off to the moon.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Ask “Where are we flying? What’s out
the window?”



Pull out staples and tape first. A grown-up
stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

45



Kitchen List

YOU NEED Paper, a crayon

Draw a list together: an apple, a cup, a spoon. Hunt for each one in the kitchen and check it off.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

“Found the spoon! What’s next on our list?”



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

46



Do What I Do

YOU NEED Just you

Touch your nose, hop on one foot, spin around once. Your child copies. Then they're the leader.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

Being the leader means practicing clear directions.



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

47



Shadow Animals

YOU NEED A flashlight, a wall

Dim the lights. Shine the flashlight on a wall and make hand shadows: a bird, a dog, a bunny.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Ask “What animal is this?” Let them guess, then try a new one.



A grown-up holds the flashlight. Battery covers stay closed.

● 3–5 yrs

48



Book Bridge

YOU NEED Books or blocks, toy cars

Build a bridge between two stacks.
Drive cars over it. Make it longer. Will it hold?



TALK TIP · WONDER ALOUD

Say “I wonder if it will hold?” Then wait and see.



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

49



Sock Match

YOU NEED A pile of clean socks

Dump the socks out. Race to find matching pairs. Roll each pair into a ball.



TALK TIP • OFFER A CHOICE

Hold up two: “Same or different?”



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

50



Water Painting

YOU NEED A cup of water, a paintbrush

Outside, “paint” a fence, a step or the sidewalk with water. Watch the picture dry and disappear.



TALK TIP · WONDER ALOUD

“Where did it go? I wonder if the sun dried it.”



Play away from the street. A grown-up stays nearby.



3–5 yrs

51



Feelings Faces

YOU NEED A mirror

Make faces in the mirror together: happy, sad, surprised, grumpy. Guess each other's face.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

“Your eyebrows went up. Surprised!”
Ask when they felt that way.



A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

52



Sound Walk

YOU NEED A walk outside

Stand still and listen. Count sounds on your fingers: a bird, a car, the wind. Walk on and listen again.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

Whisper “What do you hear?” Take turns naming sounds.



Hold hands near the street. A grown-up stays close.

MAKE IT YOURS



Your own play

TITLE

YOU NEED

THE PLAY



TALK TIP

Ages:

0-1

1-2

2-3

3-5